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Golf ball teeing device and stand therefor

Abstract

A golf ball teeing device allows a tee with a golf ball balanced thereon, to be securely pierced into the ground, without having to bend over.

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Background/Summary

BACKGROUND OF THE INVENTION

(1) The present invention is directed to a golf ball teeing device which allows a golf ball to be

placed on a tee and then implanted in the ground, without the golfer having to bend over. More particularly, the present invention is directed to such teeing device which reliably secures such a golf ball and tee on the ground, requiring a minimum of mechanical components which reliably perform with minimal amount of maintenance required or danger of breaking.

(2) Golf ball teeing devices are known to provide for inserting a tee in the ground with a golf ball placed thereon. For example, WO 2022/029726 discloses such a golf aid device including a first spring interconnecting jaws for holding the golf ball and tee, and biasing such jaws closed. The jaws are interconnected by a taut cable interconnecting the jaws to a button at a remote end of the device. Depressing this button slackens the cable, allowing a second spring to bias the jaws into open position, and release the golf ball and tee from grip of the jaws.

(3) U.S. Pat. Pub. No. 2004/0029633 is also directed to a golf ball and tee setter having a spring laterally biasing jaws of a ball cage closed, with downward pressure from a push rod at a remote end forcing the jaws open against the action of the spring. However, such devices require a large number of springs often biasing in opposition to one another. Such springs have finite operational life and can be easily deformed and bent out of shape.

(4) Accordingly, it is an object of the present invention to improve reliably of mounting a golf ball and tee on the ground, especially from a standing position.

(5) It is also an object of the present invention to provide for such mounting of a golf ball and tee with a device requiring a minimal number of components that can be easily serviced and not prone to breakage.

(6) It is another object of the present invention to allow such golf ball teeing device to be securely mounted on the ground in upright position, when not in use.

SUMMARY OF THE INVENTION

(7) These and other objects are provided by present invention, which is directed to a golf ball teeing device which allows a tee with a golf ball balanced thereon, to be securely pierced into the ground, without having to bend over.

(8) The jaws of the device are biased closed, with a golf ball first positioned therebetween, and then a tee slid on top of the golf ball while the device is inverted. Then, the device is inverted and the tee pierced into the ground. A button on an opposite end of the device is then depressed to bias the jaws apart against action of biasing means and release both the tee and golf ball situated thereon.

(9) More particularly, the golf ball teeing device has a seat for a golf ball, a pair of jaws arranged on either side of the golf ball seat and forming an opening for a tee for the golf ball at mating ends thereof, means for biasing the jaws together, a rod arranged to open the jaws against the biasing and release the golf ball and tee from therebetween, a tubular shaft on which the jaws are pivotally mounted, and through which the rod movably extends along the shaft, the rod being configured, when pushed, to contact the jaws and pivotally open them against said biasing means, a meshing gear situated at an end of the rod, and a pair of meshing gears each pivotally arranged on a respective jaw and interlocking with the meshing gear at the end of the rod. Pushing the rod against the action of the biasing means pivots the jaws outwardly from one another.

(10) This arrangement facilitates mounting of a golf ball and tee during golfing, with minimal effort, and avoiding components prone to failure or distortion. A stand for securely mounting the teeing device in upright position is also provided.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

(1) The features of the present invention will be described in greater detail with reference to the accompanying drawings, wherein

(2) FIG. 1 is a perspective view of an embodiment of the golf ball teeing device,

- (3) FIG. 2 is a perspective view of the interior mechanisms of FIG. 1,
- (4) FIG. 3 is a partially transparent perspective view of the top part of the golf ball teeing device,
- (5) FIG. 4 is a perspective view of the interior mechanism in top part shown in FIG. 3,
- (6) FIG. 5 is a side view of the bottom part of the golf ball teeing device,
- (7) FIG. 6 is a partially transparent side view of the bottom part shown in FIG. 5,
- (8) FIG. 7 is a perspective view of a portion of the internal mechanism of the bottom part of the golf ball teeing device of FIG. 6,
- (9) FIG. 8 is an exploded view showing the individual components forming a stand for the golf ball teeing device,
- (10) FIG. 9 is an enlarged partial plan view showing the certain of the individual components of FIG. 8,
- (11) FIG. 10 is an enlarged, partially transparent, perspective view of the top of the stand of FIGS. 8 and 9,
- (12) FIG. 11 is a top plan view of the teeing device and stand of FIG. 9, showing the triggering mechanism,
- (13) FIG. 12 schematically illustrates the stand and golf ball teeing device extended in upright position to support the teeing device,
- (14) FIG. 13 schematically illustrates the stand and golf ball teeing device retracted together for transport,
- (15) FIG. 14 schematically illustrates piercing the tee into the ground with the golf ball positioned on top thereof, by the golf ball teeing device,
- (16) FIG. 15 schematically illustrates lifting the golf ball teeing device away from the mounted golf ball and tee shown in FIG. 14,
- (17) FIG. 16 schematically illustrates another embodiment of the stand supporting the golf ball teeing device in upright position, and
- (18) FIG. 17 is an enlarged view of the dotted encircled area in FIG. 16.

DESCRIPTION OF THE PREFERRED EMBODIMENTS

- (19) As shown in the figures, the golf ball teeing device **100** has a pair of jaws **200** located at the bottom end and which are connected by a rod **301** to a releasing mechanism **400** at the top of the device **100**. A golf ball is first loaded into a closed position of the jaws **200** of the device **100**, onto an end of a collar **201** having a receptacle or curved indentation **203** for the ball. One jaw **200** has an L-shaped protrusion **202** to help guide and seat the golf ball during loading and each jaw **200**, as well as the collar **201**, has a respective curved indentation **203** to effectively seat the golf ball when inserted between the jaws **200** with the tee.
- (20) The tee is then loaded on top of the golf ball in the inverted position, by pressing the jaws **200** apart against biasing of the spring **401** at the top end of the gripping handle, and slipped in between the tips of the jaws **200** within the tee opening **204**, which then snaps back upon release.
- (21) The device **100** is then inverted, as the tee is appropriately pierced into the ground (FIG. 14), i.e., at the teeing off location, driving range, etc. The button **402** within the releasing mechanism **400** is then pressed and opens the jaws **200** to release the golf ball and tee from the device **100** (FIG. 15). Depressing the button **402** pushes the rod **301** situated within the tubular shaft **300** downwardly, and which then moves an opposite end of the rod **301** which is attached to a gear rack **205**, thus translating the lateral motion of the rod **301** to a rotational motion of the pinion gears **206** attached by pivot pins **207** to the jaws **200**, to open the jaws **200**. The pivot pins **207** pass through a collar **201** mounted on the end of the tubular shaft **300**, and attach the jaws **200** to the pinion gears **206**. The collar **201** securely holds the jaws **200** and pinion gears **206** in place relative to the gear rack **205**. Other attachment means of the jaws **200** to the pinion gears **206** are contemplated.
- (22) When the button **402** is then released as the teeing device is lifted up and away from the golf ball and tee pierced into the ground (FIG. 15), the jaws **200** return to closed position by the action of the biasing compression spring **401** located within the releasing mechanism **400**, extending

around the internal rod **301**, and coupled to the actuating button **402**. The releasing mechanism **400** is formed as a handle similar to a golf club gripping end, with another locking button **403** integrated into the releasing mechanism **400** and which can be used to lock the actuating button **402** in the closed position of the jaws **200** by inserting into a groove **405** of the button **402**. The locking button **403** is held against tension of a locking spring **404** and can be easily released to allow the device to be actuated by depressing the actuating button **402**. This locking can ensure the device **100** remains closed during transport as well as keeping the jaws **200** closed during use. The locking button is arranged to engage and lock the actuating button from triggering, from only the side of the actuating button on which the locking button is mounted.

(23) The present invention also facilitates picking up the tee and golf ball. For example, the button **402** can be depressed to move the jaws **200** apart against the action of the spring **401**, and placed over the tee or golf ball. Then, releasing the button **402** will allow the jaws **200** to close around the golf ball or tee and, with the locking button **403** engaged to ensure jaws **200** remained closed, the golf ball or tee can then be lifted without a golfer bending down.

(24) While the device **100** can readily fit within a standard golf bag, a stand **500** is also provided to allow the device **100** to be balanced in upright position, without having to be laid along the ground, as best seen in FIGS. **12** and **13**. The stand **500** is not intended to be limited to only the device presented, but any rod-shaped device such as a golf club, fishing pole, or any other device primarily consisting of a rod. The stand **500** works in conjunction with the device **100** to form a tripod. The stand **500** has two additional legs **510** affixed to a slider **520**. The slider **520** has a cavity, i.e., an eccentrically-winding channel **521** allowing travel along a predetermined path relative to a stationary retaining pin **530** extending therethrough. The slider **520** also has two edges or camming surfaces, a first leading edge **522** and second angled leading edge **523**, both of which are formed to mate with the tubular shaft **300**.

(25) The stand **500** is enclosed by a housing **540** permanently attached to the device **100**, and the retaining pin **530** holds the slider **520** within the housing **540**. The slider **520** also has a lever **550** affixed and stationary relative to the slider **520**. FIG. **13** shows the stand legs **510** retracted against the shaft **300** of the teeing device **100**, e.g., for carrying and/or inserting in a golf bag.

(26) To extend and mount the legs **510** of the stand, one presses down on the lever **550** which causes the slider **520** to follow the path guided by the retaining pin **530** extending through the cavity **521**, in a motion that initially lowers the legs **510**, thus moving the first leading edge **522** that is mated with the tubular shaft **300**, and then projecting the legs **510** outwardly and away from one another, by engaging the second leading edge **523** mated with the tubular shaft **300**, to form a tripod with the teeing device **100** itself (FIG. **12**).

(27) Placing the tripod on the ground will also cause upward pressure, stabilizing the device **100**. The legs **510** are also shaped to extend around the shaft **300** when engaged. While the drawings depict the stand **500** permanently attached to the device **100**, other attachment means, both permanently and semi-permanently, are contemplated.

(28) An advantage provided by this type of stand **500** coupled to the teeing device **100**, is moving the pair of legs **510** of the stand away from a user to reliably mount the teeing device **100** upright with swift action and the teeing device **100** itself forming the third leg of a tripod mounting. This makes it easier for a golfer to mount the teeing device upright between use.

(29) FIGS. **16** and **17** illustrate another type of stand for supporting the golf ball teeing device in upright position, in which the stand has just a single support leg **510'**. In this embodiment, a collar encircles the shaft of the golf ball teeing device, and has a laterally extending clamping projection with a bore therethrough. This bore extends substantially perpendicularly to the opening through the collar and encircling the shaft.

(30) The support leg in this embodiment has an opening at the top end to receive a pivot pin or screw which also extends through the bore of the clamping projection. This pivot pin or screw is tightened to secure the collar around the shaft of the teeing device while, at the same time, allowing

the stand leg to be pivoted toward or away from the teeing shaft. Therefore, the stand leg **510'** is pivotal away from the golf ball teeing device shaft to support the golf ball teeing device at an angle in upright position as shown in FIG. **16** (and is provided with a sharp bottom end to effectively pierce the ground).

(31) The preceding description of the present invention is merely exemplary and not intended to limit the scope thereof in any way.

Claims

1. A golf ball teeing device, comprising a seat for a golf ball, a pair of jaws arranged on either side of the golf ball seat and forming an opening for a tee for the golf ball at mating ends thereof, means for biasing the jaws together, a rod arranged to open the jaws against the biasing means and release the golf ball and tee from therebetween, a tubular shaft on which the jaws are pivotally mounted, and through which the rod movably extends along the shaft, the rod being configured, when pushed, to contact the jaws and pivotally open them against said biasing means, a meshing gear situated at an end of the rod, and a pair of meshing gears each pivotally arranged on a respective jaw and interlocking with the meshing gear at the end of the rod, such that pushing the rod against the action of the biasing means pivots the jaws outwardly from one another, wherein one of the jaws has an additional L-shaped protrusion to help guide and seat a golf ball during loading and teeing, and extending from said one jaw along one side of said golf ball seat towards the other of the jaws between said shaft and said golf ball tee opening defined by said jaws.
2. The device of claim 1, additionally comprising an actuating button movably mounted upon a spring extending around an opposite end of the rod from the jaws, said spring constituting said biasing means, such that depressing the button, forces the jaws apart against biasing action of the spring.
3. The device of claim 1, additionally comprising a stand pivotally mounted on the tubular shaft.
4. The device of claim 2, additionally comprising a locking button arranged to seat in a groove on the actuating button and lock the same against triggering opening of the jaws.
5. The device of claim 3, wherein the stand comprises a pair of legs arranged to pivot downwardly and outwardly in parallel to support the device in upright position.
6. The device of claim 5, wherein the stand additionally comprises a housing at an upper end thereof, and having a through-hole through which the device extends.
7. The device of claim 1, additionally comprising a collar mounted at an end of the tubular shaft and on which the jaws are pivotally mounted, the collar having a receptacle on a surface thereof for a golf ball.
8. The device of claim 4, additionally comprising a second spring on which said locking button is movably mounted to lock the jaws from triggering against biasing action of the second spring.
9. The device of claim 8, wherein the locking button is arranged to engage and lock the actuating button from triggering, from only the side of the actuating button on which the locking button is mounted.
10. The device of claim 8, wherein the actuating and locking buttons are mounted substantially perpendicular to one another.
11. Mechanism for locking a golf ball teeing device against opening and comprising a locking button arranged to laterally reciprocate in a groove on an actuating button arranged to open jaws coupled thereto and release a golf ball and tee held between the jaws when depressed, and a spring arranged to bias said locking button away from said groove, such that when said locking button is depressed and held against action of said spring, said actuating button is locked against movement, and when said locking button is released, said actuating button is unlocked and free to move, wherein the locking button is entirely arranged on one side of said actuating button, the locking button is positioned to be inserted into the groove of the actuating button by being depressed, and

said groove is located between a top end of said actuating button and a compression spring biasing said actuating button in a direction away from said locking button.

12. A golf ball teeing device, comprising a seat for a golf ball, a pair of jaws arranged on either side of the golf ball seat and forming an opening for a tee for the golf ball at mating ends thereof, means for biasing the jaws together, a rod arranged to open the jaws against the biasing means and release the golf ball and tee from therebetween, a tubular shaft on which the jaws are pivotally mounted, and through which the rod movably extends along the shaft, the rod being configured, when pushed, to contact the jaws and pivotally open them against said biasing means, a meshing gear situated at an end of the rod, a pair of meshing gears each pivotally arranged on a respective jaw and interlocking with the meshing gear at the end of the rod, such that pushing the rod against the action of the biasing means pivots the jaws outwardly from one another, a locking button arranged to laterally reciprocate in a groove on an actuating button arranged to open the jaws coupled thereto and release a golf ball and tee held between the jaws when depressed, and a spring arranged to bias said locking button away from said groove, such that when said locking button is depressed and held against action of said spring, said actuating button is locked against movement, and when said locking button is released, said actuating button is unlocked and free to move.

13. The device of claim 1, wherein one end of said L-shaped protrusion is affixed to said one jaw, and an opposite end of said L-shaped protrusion extends toward said other jaw in a perpendicular direction.

14. The device of claim 13, wherein said other end of said L-shaped protrusion extends between said two jaws in a direction perpendicular to a pivoting axis of said two jaws.

15. The device of claim 14, wherein said L-shaped protrusion is positioned to extend between said meshing gear and the mating end of said jaws.
